HUMAN RESOURCES POLICY HANDBOOK

PRACTICE SAMPLE • FICTIONAL COMPANY

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Training document for reading, summarization, question answering, and RAG pipeline practice. All company names, rules, dates, and figures in this handbook are fictional.

1. Purpose and Scope

This handbook describes example workplace policies for **Northstar Digital Services Pvt. Ltd.** (the “Company”). It is designed as a sample knowledge document and is not a statement of any real employer’s policy.

The policies apply to full-time and part-time employees unless a section says otherwise. Contractors, interns, and temporary workers should follow the provisions identified in their agreements and any applicable site rules.

1.1 Policy principles

• Treat colleagues, customers, vendors, and visitors with dignity and respect.

• Apply policies consistently, fairly, and without unlawful discrimination.

• Protect confidential information, company property, and customer data.

• Ask Human Resources (HR) or a manager when a policy is unclear.

2. Working Hours and Attendance

The standard schedule is Monday to Friday, 9:30 a.m. to 6:30 p.m., including a one-hour meal break. Some teams may follow shift schedules or customer-aligned hours approved by their department head.

2.1 Attendance

• Employees must record attendance using the approved time and attendance system.

• Employees who expect to be late should notify their manager as early as possible.

• Repeated unexplained lateness or absence may result in corrective action.

• Managers are responsible for reviewing attendance records and correcting genuine errors.

2.2 Overtime and shift changes

Overtime must be approved in writing by the manager before it is worked, except where an urgent incident makes prior approval impracticable. Approved overtime will be handled according to the employee’s contract and applicable law. Shift changes should normally be requested at least three working days in advance.

3. Leave and Holidays

Leave requests should be submitted through the HR portal and approved by the reporting manager. Approval depends on available balance, business requirements, and applicable law. Employees should not assume leave is approved until they receive confirmation.

Leave type	Illustrative annual allowance	Request guidance
Casual leave	8 working days	Request at least 2 working days ahead where possible
Sick leave	8 working days	Notify manager promptly; documentation may be requested for extended absence
Earned / privilege leave	15 working days	Request at least 7 calendar days ahead where possible
Public holidays	As per annual holiday calendar	Calendar is published by HR

Important: The allowances above are fictional examples. Actual leave entitlements, carry-forward, encashment, and statutory holidays must be determined by the applicable employment terms and local law.

4. Remote and Hybrid Work

Eligible roles may work remotely up to two days per week with manager approval. Employees must remain reachable during agreed working hours, attend required meetings, and maintain a secure workspace.

• Use company-approved devices and secure network connections.

• Do not allow family members or other third parties to use company devices.

• Report lost devices, suspected account compromise, or accidental data disclosure immediately.

• Managers may change remote-work arrangements based on operational requirements.

5. Code of Conduct and Workplace Behaviour

Employees are expected to act honestly, professionally, and in the Company's legitimate interests.

• Harassment, bullying, intimidation, discrimination, and retaliation are prohibited.

• Conflicts of interest must be disclosed to HR or the employee's manager.

• Gifts or hospitality that could influence a business decision must be declined or disclosed under the gifts procedure.

• Company communication channels must not be used for unlawful, abusive, or threatening conduct.

5.1 Raising a concern

Employees may raise concerns with their manager, HR, or the designated ethics contact. Reports will be handled as discreetly as reasonably possible. The Company prohibits retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith.

6. Information Security and Acceptable Use

• Keep passwords confidential and use multi-factor authentication where available.

• Store company and customer information only in approved systems.

• Do not install unapproved software or bypass security controls.

• Lock screens when away from devices and securely dispose of printed confidential material.

• Report phishing messages, malware alerts, data loss, and suspected security incidents to IT immediately.

Access to systems is granted according to job responsibilities and should be removed or adjusted promptly when an employee changes role or leaves the Company.

7. Performance and Learning

Managers should set clear objectives, provide regular feedback, and document material performance discussions. The sample review cycle consists of quarterly check-ins and an annual performance review.

• Objectives should be specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound where practical.

• Employees should discuss barriers early and request support when needed.

• Learning requests may be submitted to the manager with the expected business benefit and estimated cost.

• Performance ratings do not automatically guarantee a salary increase, promotion, or bonus.

8. Compensation and Benefits

Salary is paid monthly, normally on the last working day of the month, subject to payroll processing and statutory requirements. Payslips are made available through the employee self-service portal.

Eligibility for insurance, retirement benefits, allowances, incentives, and reimbursements is governed by the employee's offer letter, benefit plan documents, and applicable law. Employees should submit accurate claims with supporting receipts within 30 calendar days of the expense.

9. Travel and Expense Reimbursement

• Obtain manager approval before booking business travel, except in a documented emergency.

• Choose reasonably priced transport and accommodation consistent with the approved travel class.

• Submit expense claims within 30 calendar days after travel, attaching itemized receipts.

• Personal expenses, fines, and unapproved upgrades are not reimbursable.

10. Grievance and Disciplinary Process

The Company aims to resolve workplace concerns promptly and fairly. Depending on the issue, the process may include an informal discussion, a written complaint, fact-finding, a meeting with the employee, and a written outcome.

Corrective action may include coaching, a verbal warning, a written warning, a performance improvement plan, or further action up to and including termination, subject to due process and applicable law. The sequence may vary depending on the seriousness and circumstances of the matter.

11. Separation and Exit

Employees who resign should submit written notice to their manager and HR in accordance with their employment agreement. The manager and HR will confirm the applicable notice period, handover plan, and final working date.

• Complete knowledge transfer and return company property by the agreed date.

• Access to company systems may be changed or withdrawn based on business and security needs.

• Final settlement, including eligible unpaid salary and approved reimbursements, will be processed according to company procedures and applicable law.

• Employees must continue to protect confidential information after employment ends.

12. Policy Administration

HR owns this handbook and coordinates reviews at least once every 12 months. The Company may amend, replace, or withdraw a policy, subject to applicable law and contractual obligations. Where a conflict exists, applicable law and the employee’s binding employment documents take precedence over this practice sample.

Questions about interpretation should be sent to hr@northstardigital.example. This example address is not a real mailbox.

Appendix A. Quick Reference

Topic	Sample rule
Standard hours	Monday–Friday, 9:30 a.m.–6:30 p.m.
Remote work	Up to 2 days per week for eligible roles, with approval
Leave requests	Submit through HR portal; wait for approval
Expense claims	Submit within 30 calendar days with receipts
Performance reviews	Quarterly check-ins and annual review
Security incidents	Report immediately to IT
Policy review	At least once every 12 months

Appendix B. Practice Questions

1. What are the standard working days and hours in this sample policy?
2. How many days in advance should earned leave normally be requested?
3. Who must approve overtime before it is worked?
4. What should an employee do after noticing a phishing message?
5. Within how many calendar days should an expense claim be submitted?
6. How often is the performance review cycle conducted?
7. Which documents take precedence if this sample handbook conflicts with binding employment terms?
8. Name two examples of conduct prohibited by the code of conduct.

Use this document to practise PDF text extraction, chunking, embeddings, semantic search, and grounded question answering. For example, ask: “What is the remote-work allowance?” or “Summarize the exit process.”